Algebras Determined by a Braided-Symmetric Product

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ABSTRACT
An algebra is zero product determined when every bilinear map that vanishes on the pairs with zero product factors through the product. We replace the product by any bilinear map μ and ask the same question. For the symmetrized products μ_σ, this asks when the algebra with that product is zero product determined, and hence, for an involution σ, when the braided-symmetric derivations of that product can be studied through zero products. The answer is a criterion in terms of the kernel of the induced map $A \otimes A \to A$, and it needs no surjectivity hypothesis. For the symmetrized products of three braidings on a commutative algebra, with α an endomorphism in the twisted case, μ has the form $f(xy)$ with f linear. The same holds on any algebra when the twist reverses products. Every unital zero product determined algebra is determined by every such μ. The converse holds when f is injective, so the identity braiding gives nothing new in characteristic other than 2. The converse fails for the twisted braiding, because the dual numbers are determined by their twisted product but are not zero product determined. A computation over $\mathbb{F}_3$ shows that the algebra of 2×2 matrices is determined by a twisted product that has no form $f(xy)$.

KEYWORDS
zero product determined algebra; braided-symmetric product; Jordan product; dual numbers

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1. Introduction

This section explains the question, states the answers and describes the plan. Let K be a field and let A be a unital associative K-algebra. Many properties of an algebra are decided by the pairs of elements whose product is zero [4, Preface]. This idea led to the zero product determined (zpd) algebras [4, Definition 1.1]. The notion arose from the study of commutativity preserving maps and of local derivations [4, Preface]. In both studies, results on linear maps came from bilinear maps that vanish on the pairs with zero product [4, Preface]. A basic case is a linear map $T\colon A \to B$ that preserves zero products, which means that $xy = 0$ implies $T(x)T(y) = 0$. Such maps have been studied since Banach and Lamperti [4, §7.1]. If A is zpd, then $T(x)T(y) = S(xy)$ for a linear map S [4, Theorem 7.2]. If A and B are unital and the range of T contains an

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invertible element, then T is an invertible multiple of a homomorphism [4, Theorem 7.2]. The same idea shows that every local derivation of a unital zpd associative algebra is a derivation [4, Example 1.10]. Jordan homomorphisms appear in the study of maps that preserve zero products or commutativity [4, §7.3]. The Jordan product $x \circ y = xy + yx$ has its own class, the zero Jordan product determined (zJpd) algebras [4, Definition 3.14].

The product and the Jordan product are two choices of a bilinear map. Brešar defines zpd for nonassociative algebras [4, Definition 1.1], so any bilinear map μ on A gives a nonassociative algebra (A, μ); zpd for such a pair, with μ an arbitrary bilinear map, is the setting of Brice and Huang [3]. We say that A is *determined by* μ when (A, μ) is zpd (Definition 3.1). The main purpose of this paper is to give a criterion for determination by μ and to settle the question for several classes of algebras and products. The maps μ that interest us are the symmetrized products of Adrabi [1, Section 1]. Let $m\colon A \otimes A \to A$ be the linear map with $m(x \otimes y) = xy$. In this paper a *braiding* is a linear map σ of $A \otimes A$, and we do not require $\sigma^2 = \mathrm{id}$, which differs from [1, Definition 3.1]. Its symmetrized product is $x \cdot_\sigma y = \mu_\sigma(x, y) = m(x \otimes y + \sigma(x \otimes y))$. We use three braidings. The first is the identity. The second is the swap $x \otimes y \mapsto y \otimes x$. The third is the *twisted* swap $x \otimes y \mapsto \alpha(y) \otimes \alpha(x)$, for a linear map $\alpha\colon A \to A$, which twists the swap [1, Section 4]; Adrabi [1] takes α involutive, and we do not. Their symmetrized products are $2xy$, $xy + yx$ and $xy + \alpha(y)\alpha(x)$. For an involution σ, a *braided-symmetric derivation* is a linear map D with $D(x \cdot_\sigma y) = D(x) \cdot_\sigma y + x \cdot_\sigma D(y)$ [1, Definition 3.1]. These maps are the derivations of the nonassociative algebra $(A, \cdot_\sigma)$ [1, Remark 3.4]. So an algebra determined by μ_σ, for an involution σ, is one whose braided-symmetric derivations can be studied through zero products, as local derivations are [4, Example 1.10]. Remark 3.3 takes the first step. For T with $\mu(x, y) = 0 \Rightarrow T(x)T(y) = 0$, Remark 3.2 gives the first part of Theorem 2.6 on an algebra determined by μ.

We now describe the main results. We first record the criterion that the later proofs use: it is Proposition 1.3 of Brešar for the algebra (A, μ), and Theorem 2.3 of Brice and Huang for an arbitrary bilinear μ over a commutative ring [3]. It says that A is determined by μ if and only if the tensors $x \otimes y$ with $\mu(x, y) = 0$ span the kernel of the induced map on $A \otimes A$ (Corollary 3.4). Our second result concerns products of the form $\mu(x, y) = f(xy)$ with f linear. Every unital zpd algebra is determined by every such μ (Theorem 4.1). So the zpd algebras of Brešar are determined by all these products: the matrix algebras by Theorem 4.1 and Corollary 4.6(a), the triangular algebras by Corollary 4.7. The converse holds when f is injective (Proposition 4.2). The identity braiding has this form, and so does the twisted braiding when A is commutative and α is an endomorphism (Corollary 4.4), or when α reverses products (Corollary 4.5). Our third result shows that the converse fails for non-injective f. Theorem 5.1 gives a sufficient condition, and Example 5.3 shows that the dual numbers are determined by the twisted product but are not zpd. So the twisted product describes maps on algebras that the zpd theory does not reach. Our fourth result treats a twisted product that has no form $f(xy)$. Proposition 5.4 shows by computation that $M_2(\mathbb{F}_3)$ is determined by $xy + \alpha(yx)$, for conjugation α by $\mathrm{diag}(1, -1)$. Question 5.6 asks for the general case.

We follow this order. Section 2 recalls the definitions and the results of Brešar and of Adrabi [1] that we use, and it contains no new results. Section 3 proves the criterion. Section 4 treats products of the form $f(xy)$, with matrix and triangular algebras as applications. Section 5 contains the dual numbers, the matrix computation and the open question.

2. Preliminaries

This section recalls the notions of Brešar and of Adrabi [1] that we need, and none of it is new. We recall the two basic definitions of Brešar and the equivalent forms of the first, then Definition 2.4 of Adrabi [1], and finally Definition 2.5 and Theorem 2.6 of Brešar.

Definition 2.1 ([4, Definition 1.1])**.** A nonassociative algebra A over a field F is said to be *zero product determined* if, for every bilinear functional $\varphi\colon A\times A\to F$ satisfying $\varphi(x,y)=0$ whenever $x,y\in A$ are such that $xy=0$, there exists a linear functional τ on A such that $\varphi(x,y)=\tau(xy)$ for all $x,y\in A$.

We abbreviate *zero product determined* to zpd, as Brešar [4, §1.1] does.

Definition 2.2 ([4, Definition 3.14])**.** An associative algebra A is *zero Jordan product determined* if the Jordan algebra A^+ is zero product determined.

Here A^+ has the Jordan product $x\circ y=xy+yx$ in place of xy.
The next result gives equivalent forms of the first definition.

Proposition 2.3 ([4, Proposition 1.3])**.** *Let A be a nonassociative algebra over a field F. The following conditions are equivalent. (i) A is zpd. (ii) If a bilinear functional $\varphi\colon A\times A\to F$ satisfies $\varphi(x,y)=0$ whenever $xy=0$, then $\sum_i\varphi(x_i,y_i)=0$ whenever $\sum_i x_iy_i=0$. (iii) If $\sum_i z_iw_i=0$, then $\sum_i z_i\otimes w_i$ lies in $\operatorname{span}\{x\otimes y\in A\otimes A\mid xy=0\}$. (iv) For every vector space X over F and every bilinear map $\varphi\colon A\times A\to X$ with $\varphi(x,y)=0$ whenever $xy=0$, there is a linear map $T\colon A\to X$ with $\varphi(x,y)=T(xy)$ for all $x,y\in A$.*

The next definition recalls the derivations of the symmetrized product $x\cdot_\sigma y=m(x\otimes y)+m(\sigma(x\otimes y))$, where $m\colon A\otimes A\to A$ is the linearisation of the product of A.

Definition 2.4 ([1, Definition 3.1])**.** Let A be a K-algebra and let σ be a K-linear involution of $A\otimes A$. A *braided-symmetric derivation* for σ is a K-linear map $D\colon A\to A$ that satisfies $D(x\cdot_\sigma y)=D(x)\cdot_\sigma y+x\cdot_\sigma D(y)$ for all $x,y\in A$.

The next definition and theorem show what the zpd property is used for. In them, algebras are associative [4, §7.1].

Definition 2.5 ([4, Definition 7.1])**.** A linear map T from an algebra A to an algebra B is said to be *zero product preserving* if, for all $x,y\in A$, $xy=0\implies T(x)T(y)=0$.

The next theorem uses this notion.

Theorem 2.6 ([4, Theorem 7.2])**.** *Let A and B be algebras, and let $T\colon A\to B$ be a zero product preserving linear map. If A is zpd, then there exists a linear map $S\colon A\to B$ such that $S(xy)=T(x)T(y)$ $(x,y\in A)$. Moreover, if both A and B are unital and the range of T contains an invertible element of B (in particular, if T is surjective), then $c=T(1)$ is invertible in B and there exists a homomorphism $\phi\colon A\to B$ such that $T(x)=c\phi(x)=\phi(x)c$ $(x\in A)$.*

3. Determined by a bilinear map

This section gives the definition and the criterion that later proofs use. Throughout Sections 3 to 5, A is a unital associative algebra over a field K, and $\mu\colon A \times A \to A$ is K-bilinear.

Definition 3.1. The algebra A is *determined by* μ if the nonassociative algebra (A, μ) is zpd. By Brešar [4, Proposition 1.3(iv)] this holds if and only if, for every vector space V and every bilinear map $\varphi\colon A \times A \to V$ with $\varphi(x, y) = 0$ whenever $\mu(x, y) = 0$, there is a linear map $\psi\colon A \to V$ with $\varphi(x, y) = \psi(\mu(x, y))$ for all $x, y \in A$.

For $\mu(x, y) = xy$ this is the zpd property of A, and for $\mu = \circ$ it is the zJpd property of Definition 2.2.

The next remark carries the use of Theorem 2.6 over to μ.

Remark 3.2. Let B be an algebra and let $T\colon A \to B$ be a linear map with $\mu(x, y) = 0 \Rightarrow T(x)T(y) = 0$. If A is determined by μ, apply Definition 3.1 to the bilinear map $(x, y) \mapsto T(x)T(y)$ with values in B. It gives a linear map $S\colon A \to B$ with $S(\mu(x, y)) = T(x)T(y)$. For $\mu(x, y) = xy$ this is the first part of Theorem 2.6.

The next remark does the same for derivations.

Remark 3.3. Let σ be an involution of $A \otimes A$ and let $D\colon A \to A$ be linear with $D(x) \cdot_\sigma y + x \cdot_\sigma D(y) = 0$ whenever $x \cdot_\sigma y = 0$. If A is determined by μ_σ, apply Definition 3.1 to the bilinear map $(x, y) \mapsto D(x) \cdot_\sigma y + x \cdot_\sigma D(y)$. It gives a linear map $S\colon A \to A$ with $D(x) \cdot_\sigma y + x \cdot_\sigma D(y) = S(x \cdot_\sigma y)$. So D is a braided-symmetric derivation in the sense of Definition 2.4 if and only if $S = D$ on the span of the products $x \cdot_\sigma y$.

The criterion uses the linear map $\bar{\mu}\colon A \otimes A \to A$ with $\bar{\mu}(x \otimes y) = \mu(x, y)$. Let $\mathcal{Z}_\mu$ be the subspace of $A \otimes A$ spanned by the tensors $x \otimes y$ with $\mu(x, y) = 0$. Then $\mathcal{Z}_\mu \subseteq \ker \bar{\mu}$.

Corollary 3.4. *The algebra A is determined by μ if and only if $\mathcal{Z}_\mu = \ker \bar{\mu}$.*

The criterion is stated for an arbitrary bilinear μ, over a commutative ring, by Brice and Huang [3, Theorem 2.3]; Proposition 1.3 of Brešar, recalled as Proposition 2.3, is the same statement for the product of a nonassociative algebra, and Corollary 3.4 is that statement applied to (A, μ).

Proof. Apply the equivalence of (i) and (iii) in Proposition 2.3 to the nonassociative algebra (A, μ). Condition (iii) says that $\sum_i z_i \otimes w_i \in \mathcal{Z}_\mu$ whenever $\sum_i \mu(z_i, w_i) = 0$, which is $\ker \bar{\mu} \subseteq \mathcal{Z}_\mu$. □

4. Products of the form $f(xy)$

This section treats the case $\mu(x, y) = f(xy)$ with $f\colon A \to A$ linear, which includes two of the three braidings: the identity braiding, and the twisted braiding when α is an endomorphism or reverses products (Corollaries 4.4 and 4.5).

Theorem 4.1. *Let A be a unital zpd algebra, let $f\colon A \to A$ be linear, and let $\mu(x, y) = f(xy)$. Then A is determined by μ.*

Proof. Let φ vanish on the pairs with $\mu(x, y) = 0$. If $xy = 0$ then $\mu(x, y) = 0$, so φ

vanishes on zero products. Since A is zpd, there is a linear ψ_0 with $\varphi(x,y) = \psi_0(xy)$ by Proposition 2.3(iv). Let $b \in \ker f$. Then $\mu(b,1) = f(b) = 0$, so $\psi_0(b) = \varphi(b,1) = 0$. Hence $\ker f \subseteq \ker \psi_0$, and ψ_0 induces a linear map on $A/\ker f$, which is isomorphic to the image of f. This gives a linear map on the image of f, and we extend it to a linear map ψ on A. Then $\psi(f(z)) = \psi_0(z)$ for every z, so $\varphi(x,y) = \psi(\mu(x,y))$. □

The next proposition gives the converse for injective f.

Proposition 4.2. *Let $f\colon A \to A$ be linear and injective, and let $\mu(x,y) = f(xy)$. If A is determined by μ, then A is zpd.*

Proof. Since f is injective, $\mu(x,y) = 0$ if and only if $xy = 0$. Let φ vanish on zero products. Then φ vanishes on the pairs with $\mu(x,y) = 0$, and we get ψ with $\varphi(x,y) = \psi(f(xy))$. So $\varphi(x,y) = (\psi \circ f)(xy)$. □

The identity braiding gives $\mu(x,y) = xy + xy = 2xy$, so we take $f = 2\,\mathrm{id}$.

Corollary 4.3. *Let $\mu(x,y) = 2xy$.*

(i) If A is zpd, then A is determined by μ.
(ii) If $\operatorname{char} K \neq 2$, then A is determined by μ if and only if A is zpd.

Proof. Part (i) is Theorem 4.1 with $f = 2\,\mathrm{id}$. If $\operatorname{char} K \neq 2$ this f is injective, and Proposition 4.2 gives the other direction of (ii). □

In characteristic 2 the map μ is zero, every φ in Definition 3.1 is zero, and every algebra is determined by μ.

The standard braiding gives the Jordan product, and determination by it is the zJpd property, as noted after Definition 3.1. When $\operatorname{char} K \neq 2$ the linear map $\overline{\circ}\colon A \otimes A \to A$ with $x \otimes y \mapsto x \circ y$ is onto, because $x \circ (\frac{1}{2} \cdot 1) = x$, so that $A^2 = A$; with this, Corollary 3.4 for $\mu = \circ$ is the usual form of the zJpd criterion. It is not of the form $f(xy)$ on a noncommutative algebra (indeed $x = 1$ forces $f = 2\,\mathrm{id}$: if $\operatorname{char} K \neq 2$ then $xy + yx = 2xy$ gives $yx = xy$, while if $\operatorname{char} K = 2$ then $f = 0$, so $xy + yx = 0$ for all x, y, which fails as soon as $xy \neq yx$), and we refer to Brešar [4, Section 3.3] for its theory.

The twisted braiding has the form $f(xy)$ when A is commutative and α is an endomorphism. Let α be an algebra endomorphism of A. Then $\alpha(y)\alpha(x) = \alpha(yx) = \alpha(xy)$, so $xy + \alpha(y)\alpha(x) = (\mathrm{id} + \alpha)(xy)$.

Corollary 4.4. *Let A be commutative and zpd, and let α be an algebra endomorphism of A. Then A is determined by $\mu_\alpha(x,y) = xy + \alpha(y)\alpha(x)$.*

Proof. Apply Theorem 4.1 with $f = \mathrm{id} + \alpha$. □

The same holds on a noncommutative algebra when α reverses products.

Corollary 4.5. *Let A be a unital zpd algebra, and let $\alpha\colon A \to A$ be linear with $\alpha(xy) = \alpha(y)\alpha(x)$ for all x, y. Then A is determined by $\mu_\alpha(x,y) = xy + \alpha(y)\alpha(x)$.*

Proof. Here $\alpha(y)\alpha(x) = \alpha(xy)$, so $\mu_\alpha(x,y) = (\mathrm{id} + \alpha)(xy)$. Apply Theorem 4.1 with $f = \mathrm{id} + \alpha$. □

We use a result of Brešar on matrix algebras.

For a unital algebra A_1, a unital algebra A_2 and a unital (A_1, A_2)-bimodule M, the matrices $\left[\begin{smallmatrix} r_1 & m \\ 0 & r_2 \end{smallmatrix}\right]$ with $r_1 \in A_1$, $m \in M$ and $r_2 \in A_2$ form an algebra under the usual matrix operations, which Brešar denotes by $\mathrm{Tri}(A_1, M, A_2)$ [4, §2.1].

Corollary 4.6 ([4, Corollary 2.17])**.** *The following algebras are zpd: (a) The algebra $M_n(B)$, where $n \geq 2$ and B is any unital algebra. (b) The algebra $\mathrm{Tri}(A_1, M, A_2)$, where A_1 and A_2 are unital algebras generated by idempotents and M is a unital (A_1, A_2)-bimodule.*

By Corollary 4.6(a) with $B = K$, the matrix algebra $M_n(K)$ is zpd for $n \geq 2$. The transpose reverses products [5, §0.2.5]. So Corollary 4.5 applies to $M_n(K)$ and to the transpose, and to every linear map α of $M_n(K)$ that reverses products.

Part (b) of the same corollary gives a second family, the triangular algebras.

Corollary 4.7. *Let $A = \mathrm{Tri}(A_1, M, A_2)$ be as in Corollary 4.6(b), and let $f\colon A \to A$ be linear. Then A is determined by $\mu(x, y) = f(xy)$. In particular A is determined by $xy + \alpha(y)\alpha(x)$ for every linear $\alpha\colon A \to A$ with $\alpha(xy) = \alpha(y)\alpha(x)$.*

Proof. By Corollary 4.6(b), A is zpd, and A has the unit with diagonal entries the units of A_1 and A_2. Apply Theorem 4.1, and then Corollary 4.5 for the last claim. □

The algebra of upper triangular $n \times n$ matrices over a field is of type (b) [4, Example 2.19], so Corollary 4.7 applies to it.

When α is an involution and $\operatorname{char} K \neq 2$, the map $\mathrm{id} + \alpha$ is twice the projection onto the fixed points of α. It is injective only for $\alpha = \mathrm{id}$, where the converse is Corollary 4.3(ii), so for $\alpha \neq \mathrm{id}$ Proposition 4.2 gives no converse. The next section shows that the converse is false for such an α.

5. Determined but not zpd

This section gives a sufficient condition that does not assume zpd, and applies it to the dual numbers.

Theorem 5.1. *Let $f\colon A \to A$ be linear, let $N = \ker f$, and let $\mu(x, y) = f(xy)$. Suppose that $f(1) \neq 0$, that $bn, nb \in N$ for all $n \in N$ and $b \in A$, and that there is a linear functional c on A with $x - c(x)1 \in N$ for every x. Then A is determined by μ.*

Proof. Let φ vanish on the pairs with $\mu(x, y) = 0$. If $n \in N$ then ny and xn lie in N, so $\mu(n, y) = \mu(x, n) = 0$ and $\varphi(n, y) = \varphi(x, n) = 0$. Write $x = (x - c(x)1) + c(x)1$ and do the same for y. Bilinearity gives $\varphi(x, y) = c(x)c(y)\varphi(1, 1)$. The same splitting gives $f(y) = c(y)f(1)$, and then $f(xy) = c(x)f(y) = c(x)c(y)f(1)$. Since $f(1) \neq 0$, the map $a \mapsto af(1)$ from K to A has a linear left inverse g. Put $\psi(z) = g(z)\varphi(1, 1)$. Then $\psi(f(xy)) = c(x)c(y)\varphi(1, 1) = \varphi(x, y)$. □

In words, the hypotheses say that N is a two-sided ideal of codimension 1 that does not contain 1. The next example meets them.

We also use the characterization of finite-dimensional zpd algebras by Brešar [4, Theorem 2.27].

Theorem 5.2 ([4, Theorem 2.27])**.** *A finite-dimensional unital algebra is zpd if and only if it is generated by idempotents.*

The next example uses this characterization to show that the class of algebras determined by the twisted product is strictly larger.

Example 5.3 (Dual numbers)**.** Let $\operatorname{char} K \neq 2$ and let $A = K[\varepsilon]/(\varepsilon^2)$, an algebra of the form studied in [4, Example 2.23], where a unity is adjoined to an algebra with trivial multiplication (there it is shown to be symmetrically zpd and not zpd); here that algebra is $K\varepsilon$, and the twisted product below is not the symmetrized product of that example. The map $\alpha(a + b\varepsilon) = a - b\varepsilon$ is an involutive automorphism. Since A is commutative, $\mu_\alpha(x, y) = f(xy)$ with $f = \mathrm{id} + \alpha$, and $f(a + b\varepsilon) = 2a$. So $N = K\varepsilon$, which is an ideal, $f(1) = 2 \neq 0$, and $c(a + b\varepsilon) = a$ satisfies the last hypothesis. By Theorem 5.1, A is determined by μ_α. The only idempotents of A are 0 and 1, so A is not generated by idempotents. By Theorem 5.2, A is not zpd.

So the twisted braiding determines a class of algebras strictly larger than the zpd ones, even among commutative algebras. When α is an automorphism of a noncommutative algebra, the twisted product $xy + \alpha(yx)$ is not of the form $f(xy)$ (indeed $y = 1$ forces $f = \mathrm{id} + \alpha$, and then $\alpha(yx) = \alpha(xy)$, so $yx = xy$ by injectivity of α), and Theorems 4.1 and 5.1 do not apply. The criterion of Corollary 3.4 still applies. The next proposition uses it on the smallest case over a field of odd characteristic (over $\mathbb{F}_2$, $M_2(\mathbb{F}_2)$ with α the conjugation by $\left[\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right]$ is smaller and gives the same conclusion: the kernel has dimension 13 and the zero pairs span 13).

Proposition 5.4. *Let $A = M_2(\mathbb{F}_3)$ and let α be conjugation by* $\operatorname{diag}(1, -1)$*, an involutive automorphism. Then A is determined by $\mu_\alpha(x, y) = xy + \alpha(yx)$.*

Proof. Here $A \otimes A$ has dimension 16 over $\mathbb{F}_3$. By Corollary 3.4, we must show $\mathcal{Z}_{\mu_\alpha} = \ker \bar{\mu}_\alpha$, and the inclusion $\mathcal{Z}_{\mu_\alpha} \subseteq \ker \bar{\mu}_\alpha$ always holds. The matrix of $\bar{\mu}_\alpha$ in the bases of matrix units has rank 4 over $\mathbb{F}_3$, so $\dim \ker \bar{\mu}_\alpha = 12$. Among the $81 \cdot 81$ pairs (x, y), exactly 417 satisfy $\mu_\alpha(x, y) = 0$. Gaussian elimination over $\mathbb{F}_3$ shows that the 417 tensors $x \otimes y$ span a subspace of dimension 12. So the two subspaces have the same dimension and are equal. □

The same computation gives $\dim \mathcal{Z} = \dim \ker = 12$ for the ordinary product, as expected since $M_2(\mathbb{F}_3)$ is zpd by Corollary 4.6(a), and $\dim \mathcal{Z} = \dim \ker = 13$ for the twist by the transpose, taken with the braiding product $xy + y^{\mathsf{T}}x^{\mathsf{T}} = xy + (xy)^{\mathsf{T}}$.

Remark 5.5. If α is inner, that is $\alpha(x) = DxD^{-1}$ for an invertible D, the twisted product is a Jordan product in disguise: for all x and y,

$$xy + \alpha(yx) = xy + (Dy)(xD^{-1}) = (xD^{-1})(Dy) + (Dy)(xD^{-1}) = (xD^{-1}) \circ (Dy).$$

Let Φ be the linear automorphism $x \otimes y \mapsto xD^{-1} \otimes Dy$ of $A \otimes A$. The identity above says $\bar{\mu}_\alpha = \bar{\circ} \circ \Phi$, so $\ker \bar{\mu}_\alpha = \Phi^{-1}(\ker \bar{\circ})$, and since Φ carries pure tensors to pure tensors, $\mathcal{Z}_{\mu_\alpha} = \Phi^{-1}(\mathcal{Z}_\circ)$. Hence A is determined by μ_α if and only if A is determined by the Jordan product, and the answer does not depend on D. In particular, for a unital algebra B and $n \geq 2$ the matrix algebra $M_n(B)$ is generated by the idempotents e_{ii} and $e_{ii} + be_{ij}$ for $i \neq j$ with $b \in B$ (indeed $be_{ij} = (e_{ii} + be_{ij}) - e_{ii}$ and $be_{ii} = (be_{ij})e_{ji}$), and a unital algebra generated by idempotents is zJpd in characteristic other than 2 [4, Theorem 3.15], originally [2, Theorem 2.1]. So $M_n(B)$ is determined by μ_α for every inner α, in characteristic other than 2, and Proposition 5.4 is the case $n = 2$ and $D = \operatorname{diag}(1, -1)$: its computation checks the criterion of Corollary 3.4 directly in a small case, and μ_α has no form $f(xy)$ by the argument above.

Question 5.6. Which noncommutative algebras with an involutive automorphism α are determined by their twisted product $xy+\alpha(yx)$? By Remark 5.5 an inner α makes the twisted product a Jordan product in disguise, so the answer is affirmative exactly for the zJpd algebras: it is affirmative for $M_n(B)$ and for the triangular algebras of Corollary 4.6(b), in characteristic other than 2, since these are zJpd [4, Corollary 3.17], and negative for the real quaternions with $\alpha = \mathrm{id}$, which are not zJpd [4, Example 3.19]. Every automorphism of $M_n(K)$, for a field K and $n \geq 2$, is inner (Skolem–Noether), so in characteristic other than 2 the matrix algebras over a field are settled; the question is about algebras admitting an involutive automorphism that is not inner.

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